

456 Bridge Road,
Cobblebank Victoria, 3338

Child Safety Code of Conduct Policy

Exported on 30 Jun 2026

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Document	Child Safety Code of Conduct Policy
Document Type	Policy
Owner	Principal
Approval Authority	Governing Authority
Version	1.0
Status	APPROVED
Approval Date	29 Jun 2026
Review Cycle	2 years
Next Review	29 Jun 2028

1. Purpose

The purpose of this Policy is to establish clear behavioural expectations that promote and support a child-safe culture at Rosewood College.

This Policy sets standards of conduct for adults interacting with children and ensures that all interactions with students are safe, respectful, professional and consistent with the College's commitment to child safety and wellbeing.

As an independent school grounded in the Catholic faith and moral tradition, Rosewood College recognises that all adults share responsibility for protecting children from abuse, harm, neglect, exploitation, grooming and other inappropriate conduct.

This Policy supports the Child Safe Standards framework and applies in conjunction with the Child Safety Policy and other child safety governance documents.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to:

- members of the Governing Authority
- the Principal
- all staff
- volunteers
- contractors
- trainee teachers
- work experience participants
- external providers
- visitors
- any person engaged in child-connected work on behalf of the College

This Policy applies whenever a person is:

- on College premises

- participating in College activities
- supervising students
- representing the College
- communicating with students
- interacting with students online
- undertaking work on behalf of the College

This Policy applies to conduct connected with Rosewood College, including conduct that occurs on College premises, during school activities, during excursions or offsite activities, online, through digital communication, outside school hours, away from College premises, or in any other context where the conduct involves a student, affects student safety or wellbeing, relates to a school-authorised activity, or may affect trust and confidence in the College's child safety arrangements.

3. Policy

3.1 Child Safety Commitment

All adults associated with Rosewood College must contribute to a culture in which:

- the safety, wellbeing and best interests of children are paramount
- children are treated with dignity and respect
- students feel safe to raise concerns
- safeguarding responsibilities are understood and fulfilled
- concerns are reported promptly
- professional boundaries are maintained

3.2 Required Standards of Conduct

All persons covered by this Policy must:

- act in the best interests of students
- treat students with respect, fairness and dignity
- promote inclusion and participation
- model respectful behaviour
- maintain appropriate professional boundaries
- comply with child safety obligations
- comply with all College policies and procedures
- report child safety concerns promptly
- take reasonable steps to protect students from foreseeable harm
- support a child-safe environment
- intervene or seek assistance when witnessing behaviour that may place a child at risk
- report actual or suspected breaches of this Policy

3.3 Professional Boundaries

Adults must maintain clear professional boundaries with students at all times.

Professional interactions must:

- be appropriate to the person's role
- support the student's educational, wellbeing or safety needs
- be transparent and capable of scrutiny
- occur within approved College arrangements

Adults must avoid relationships with students that may:

- create favouritism
- create dependency
- undermine professional judgement
- compromise child safety
- place either the student or adult at risk

Adults must discourage, reject and report any inappropriate emotional, romantic or sexual attention initiated by a student.

Any actual, potential or perceived conflict of interest affecting an adult's professional relationship with a student must be disclosed to the Principal as soon as practicable.

3.4 Acceptable Conduct

Examples of acceptable conduct include:

- listening respectfully to students
- encouraging student participation and inclusion
- maintaining appropriate supervision
- providing educational guidance and support
- responding appropriately to student wellbeing concerns
- following approved communication protocols
- using positive behaviour management practices
- supporting students to understand their rights and responsibilities
- respecting each student's dignity, background, family circumstances, faith, culture and individual needs

3.5 Unacceptable Conduct

Persons covered by this Policy must not:

- engage in any form of child abuse
- groom a child or young person
- engage in sexual conduct with a child
- engage in sexualised behaviour towards a child
- use physical punishment

- humiliate, ridicule or shame a student
- engage in conduct that demeans, excludes or unfairly targets a student because of their background, circumstances, characteristics or needs
- ignore or dismiss child safety concerns
- expose students to inappropriate material
- develop inappropriate personal relationships with students
- use inappropriate language towards students
- deliberately intimidate, threaten or coerce a student
- engage in conduct that places a child at risk of harm

3.6 Physical Contact

Physical contact with students must:

- be reasonable
- be necessary in the circumstances
- be appropriate to the student's age and developmental needs
- be responsive to the student's safety, wellbeing or educational needs
- take place in a manner that is observable and accountable

Examples of circumstances where physical contact may be appropriate include:

- providing first aid
- protecting a student from immediate harm
- assisting with mobility or disability support
- participating in approved educational or sporting activities where contact is unavoidable

Physical contact must never be:

- sexualised
- secretive
- intimidating
- unnecessary
- motivated by personal needs

3.7 One-to-One Interactions

One-to-one interactions with students must occur in circumstances that support transparency and accountability.

Adults must not conduct undisclosed, unauthorised or unnecessary private meetings with students.

Where practicable:

- interactions must occur in observable locations
- another adult must be aware of the interaction

- visibility must be maintained
- unnecessary isolation must be avoided

The College recognises that some educational, wellbeing, counselling or support activities may require individual meetings with students.

Appropriate safeguards must be maintained.

3.8 Electronic Communication and Online Conduct

Communication with students must:

- support legitimate educational, wellbeing or operational purposes
- occur through approved College communication channels wherever practicable
- be professional and respectful
- be capable of review where required

Adults must not:

- communicate with students through personal social media accounts
- establish social media relationships with students
- use personal messaging applications to communicate with students unless expressly authorised by the Principal for a legitimate College purpose and subject to safeguards
- engage in private or secretive electronic communications with students
- use electronic communication in a way that circumvents College oversight or recordkeeping

3.9 Transporting Students

Staff and other authorised persons must comply with College requirements regarding student transport.

Transport arrangements must:

- be authorised
- be documented where required
- prioritise student safety
- comply with supervision and risk management requirements

Unauthorised transport arrangements are prohibited.

3.10 Photography, Video and Images

Images, recordings and photographs of students may only be created, stored, used or shared:

- for authorised College purposes
- in accordance with College policies
- in accordance with applicable consent requirements
- in accordance with privacy obligations

Adults must not use personal devices or images in ways that compromise child safety or privacy.

3.11 Gifts, Favouritism and Personal Relationships

Adults must not:

- provide gifts that could create inappropriate influence or dependency
- show favouritism towards particular students
- seek emotional support from students
- develop relationships that blur professional boundaries

Professional judgement must always be maintained.

3.12 Reporting Obligations

All persons covered by this Policy must:

- report child safety concerns promptly
- comply with mandatory reporting obligations where applicable
- comply with reportable conduct requirements
- cooperate with child safety investigations
- support safeguarding actions
- create or contribute to required records relating to child safety concerns, disclosures, incidents or breaches

Failure to report concerns may place children at risk and may breach legal or professional obligations.

3.13 Breaches of This Policy

Actual or suspected breaches of this Policy will be taken seriously.

Breaches may result in:

- performance management action
- disciplinary action
- removal from duties
- termination of engagement
- reporting to relevant authorities
- regulatory notification
- other action considered necessary to protect children

4. Implementation

The Governing Authority is responsible for approving this Policy and maintaining oversight of child safety governance.

The Governing Authority is responsible for approving, endorsing and ensuring this Policy is made publicly available to students, parents, guardians, staff, volunteers and the school community through the College website or another approved access point.

The Principal is responsible for:

- implementing this Policy

- communicating behavioural expectations
- ensuring induction and training occurs
- monitoring compliance
- responding to breaches
- supporting a child-safe culture

All staff, volunteers, contractors and external providers are responsible for:

- complying with this Policy
- maintaining professional boundaries
- reporting concerns promptly
- participating in child safety training
- modelling appropriate conduct

The College ensures this Policy is communicated during recruitment, induction and periodic refresher training. Persons undertaking child-connected work must be informed of this Policy and must confirm that they understand and agree to comply with it before commencing relevant duties, unless the Principal approves an alternative documented arrangement due to urgent or exceptional circumstances.

5. Review

This Policy will be reviewed at least every two years, and earlier where required due to a child safety incident, reportable conduct matter, complaint, legislative change, regulatory update, audit finding, training review, identified breach pattern, safeguarding improvement, or change to Child Safe Standards requirements.

The review must consider whether the Policy remains clear, current, understood and effective in guiding safe adult behaviour with students.

The Principal is responsible for coordinating review.

Material amendments must be approved by the Governing Authority.

6. Related Documents

Related documents include:

- Child Safety Policy
- Parent Code of Conduct Policy
- Staff Code of Conduct
- Student Code of Conduct Policy